

Bhattacharjea in *Countdown to Partition: The Final Days* wrote: "New national and provincial boundaries had to be divided; the assets and liabilities of the Government of India and the Reserve Bank had to be divided; the jurisdiction of the superior courts had to be determined; diplomatic representation had to be arranged for both new nations. And now it all had to be completed in two weeks".

Dividing railway lines

The division changed the structure of two railway lines in particular, the North Western Railway (NWR) extended across West Pakistan, and the Assam Bengal Railway in East Pakistan (modern-day Bangladesh). At 11,074 km, the NWR was the longest in pre-Independence India.

Partition left India with a mere 3,034 km of the NWR line, which was briefly called the Eastern Punjab Railway. Instead of Lahore, Rawalpindi, or Peshawar (in modern-day Pakistan), Amritsar became the last hub before the border and the new terminus for all long-distance trains travelling from Bombay or Calcutta.

The Jodhpur Railway lost 513 km to Pakistan as well. The division of Bengal raised a similar problem as only 3,125 km of 5,721 km remained in Indian territory. The main connection to Calcutta no longer existed as many of the lines were now in East Pakistan. The region of Assam had an unusual problem. The Partition of Bengal and the railways had left it isolated, linked only by a small strip of land to the rest of India. Major workshops, depots, and stores were also divided with no contingencies. With Lahore now in Pakistan, telephone and telegraph communication between Delhi and Punjab broke down, so trains were used to despatch mail until the services were re-established in November 1947. It would be years before the system recovered from the scars of Partition.

Dividing human resources

The railway workforce was divided as well and the 1947–48 Interim Budget noted that approximately 126,300 employees opted for India and had to be accommodated and awarded new assignments. There was also the matter of, what Canadian historian Ian J Kerr called, the